RISA

Timeless Tribal

Weaving India's Tribal Heritage into a Global Brand



Every tribal weave tells a story of heritage, identity and resilience. Across India, tribal communities have preserved remarkable traditions of weaving, embroidery and handicrafts using natural fibres and indigenous techniques. Beyond safeguarding India's cultural legacy, these crafts provide livelihoods to thousands of artisans, particularly women.

Despite growing global demand for authentic handmade and sustainable products, tribal artisans continue to face fragmented production, limited design support, weak branding, inadequate packaging and poor market access, reducing the value they receive for their craftsmanship.

To change this, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs has launched **RISA – Timeless Tribal**, a flagship initiative that transforms tribal weaves, embroideries and handicrafts into premium, globally competitive products through design innovation, cluster development, value addition, branding and stronger market linkages. By supporting finished designer products and direct market access through TRIFED, RISA ensures greater value reaches tribal communities.

The RISA brand was officially launched by Shri Jual Oram, Hon'ble Union Minister of Tribal Affairs, during Bharat Tribes Fest (BTF), on 18th March 2026 at Sunder Nursery, New Delhi.

Mission

- Build premium global brands rooted in tribal heritage.
- Create ethical value chains that maximise artisans' incomes.
- Preserve traditional knowledge while empowering tribal women.
- Strengthen clusters through design, infrastructure, skills and market access.

RISA is anchored in six interventions: contemporary design, value added products, sustainable packaging, artisan skill development, infrastructure upgradation and stitching units within weaving clusters. In its first phase, it covers 10 artisan clusters, representing seven tribal textile and embroidery traditions and three handicraft clusters, benefiting thousands of tribal artisans and their families.







The selected traditions include **Eri Silk** and **Muga Silk** from Assam, **Santhal Cotton** from Jharkhand, **Changpa Pashmina** and **Turtuk Brass Cutlery** from Ladakh, **Kotpad Cotton** and **Dongria Embroidery** from Odisha, **Toda Embroidery** from Tamil Nadu, **Longpi Pottery** from Manipur and **Dokhra Art**.

The National Design Centre, under the Ministry of Textiles, is implementing the initiative with designers **Abu Jani and Sandeep Khosla, Manish Tripathi, Anju Modi, Gaurav Jai Gupta and Sameera Dalvi.** The National Institute of Design, Haryana, has created sustainable premium packaging for the RISA brand.

Vision

- Expand to more tribal clusters across India.
- Promote GI tagged tribal products.
- Establish exclusive RISA flagship boutiques in major cities across India.
- Strengthen digital market access and showcase tribal craftsmanship globally.

Named after Tripura's **GI tagged Risa,** the initiative reflects authenticity and heritage. The first flagship **RISA store at the State Emporia Complex, Baba Kharak Singh Marg, New Delhi,** was inaugurated by **Smt. Ranjana Chopra, IAS, Secretary, Ministry of Tribal Affairs, on 10 June 2026,** marking the beginning of RISA's national journey.

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